Japanese Word	Approximate Pronunciation	Approximate Meaning
Eri Dori	Eh-ree Doe-ree	Collar Grab
Gyakute Dori; Ai Hanmi Katate Dori	Gyah-koo-teh Doe-ree	Kosa Dori (see below)
Hiji Dori	He-jee Doe-ree	Elbow Grab
Kata Dori	Kah-tah Doe-ree	Shoulder Grab
Katate Dori; Katate Mochi; Gyaku Hanmi Katate Dori	Kah-tah-teh Doe-ree	Single Wrist Grab, Same-side Hand
Kosa Dori; Gyakute Dori; Ai Hanmi Katate Dori	Koh-sah Doe-ree	Single Wrist Grab, Opposite-side Hand
Kubi Shime	Kooh-be Shee-mey	Neck Choke
Morote Dori, Katate Ryote Dori, Katate Ryuote Mochi	Moe-roe-toe Doe-ree	Two Hands on One Forearm Grab
Muna Dori	Moo-nah Doe-ree	Lapel Grab
Mune Tsuki	Moo-net-skee	Chest/Stomach Punch or thrust
Ryo	Ree-oh	Both (eg., Ryote Dori: each wrist grabbed)
Shomen Uchi	Show-mehn Oo-chhi	Top of the Head Strike
Sode Dori	Soe-day Doe-ree	Sleeve Grab
Ushiro	Oo-she-roe	From the Rear
Ushiro Dori	Oo-she-roe Doe-ree	Bear Hug From Behind
Ushiro Tekubi Dori	Oo-she-roe Tay-koo-be Doe-ree	Wrist held from behind (opposite hand)
Yokomen Uchi	Yo-co-mehn Oo-chhi	Side of the Head Strike

Defenses:

Japanese Word	Approximate Pronunciation	Approximate Meaning
Ago tsuki Age	Ah-goh-skee-ah-gay	Chin twist strike
Aiki Nage	Eye-key Nah-gee	Hip Throw Holding Both of Uke's Legs
Gokyo	Go-kyoh	Fifth Form
Hiji Nage	Hee-gee Nah-gee	Elbow Throw
Ikkyo	Ee-kyoh	First form; "putting the weight on". Also *Ikkajo*
Irimi Nage	Ee-ree-mee Nah-gee	Entering Throw
Juji Garame	Joo-gee-guh-rah-mey	"Cross-twine" throw
Kaiten Nage	Kigh-ten Nah-gee	Rotary Throw
Kokyu Ho	Co-kew Ho	"Breath method": the fundamental teaching of Aikido technique
Kokyu Nage	Co-kew Nah-gee	Literally: Breath throw; not one of the other throws
Koshi Nage	Co-she Nah-gee	Hip Throw
Kote Gaeshi	Co-teh Gah-eh-she	Wrist Twist/Return
Nikkyo	Knee-kyoh	Second form. Also *Nikkajo*
Rokyo	Roe-kyoh	Sixth Form
Sankyo	Sahn-kyoh	Third form. Also *Sankajo*
Shiho Nage	Shee-ho Nah-gee	Four Direction Throw
Sumi Otoshi	Sue-mee Oh-toe-she	Corner Throw
Tenchi Nage	Tehn-chee Nah-gee	Heaven and Earth
Ude Osai	Oo-day Oh-sah-ay	Arm Pin
Yonkyo	Yohn-kyoh	Fourth form. Also *Yonkajo*

Weapons Terms

Japanese Word	Approximate Pronunciation	Approximate Meaning
Awase	Ah-wah-say	Paired Partner Practice: Harmonious Movement Without Contact
Bokken	Bow-ken	Wooden Practice Sword
Buki	Boo-kee	Weapons, arms
Ha	Hah	Blade Edge
Jo	Joe	Wooden Staff, Approximately 50 in
Kashira	Kah-she-rah	Butt Cap of sword
Katana	Kah-tah-nah	Sword
Ken	Ken	Sword
Kesa Giri	Kay-sah Gi-ree	Diagonal Cut Across Body
Kissaki	Kiss-sah-key	Tip of sword
Kobudo	Koh-boo-doe	Traditional Weapons Arts
Kumi Jo	Koo-me-joe	Paired Partner Staff Practice with Contact
Kumi Tachi	Koo-me Tah-chee	Paired Partner Sword Practice with Contact
Muna, Mune	Moo-nah, Moo-nay	Chest
Saya	Sah-yah	Scabbard
Shinai	She-nie	Bamboo Sword; if Covered: Yagyu Shinai
Shoto	Show-toe	Short Sword
Suburi	Sue-boo-ree	Solo Practice Movement Using the Ken or Jo
Tachi	Tah-chee	Sword
Tanto	Tahn-toe	Wooden Knife
Tsuba	Tsue-bah	Guard
Tsuka	Tsue-kah	Hilt

Sword Stances & Cuts

Japanese Word	Approximate Pronunciation	Approximate Meaning
Chudan-no-kamae	Choo-dhahn-no-kuh-mah-ey	Middle stance
Gedan-no-kamae	gay-daan-noh-kuh-mah-ey	Low forward stance on right
Gyaku gedan-no-kamae	gyah-kooh- "	Low forward stance on *left*
Gedan-hasso-no-kamae	gay-daan-hah-soh--noh-kuh-mah-ey	Low rear stance on right
Gyaku-gedan-hasso-no-kamae	gyah-kooh- "	Low rear stance on *left*
Hasso-no-kamae	hah-soh-noh-kuh.mah-ey	"Figure 8" stance near right shoulder
Gyaku Hasso-no-kamae	gyah-kooh- "	"Figure 8" stance near *left* shoulder
Jodan-no-kamae	Joe-dahn -no-kuh-mah-ey	High Stance; sword hilt over head
Jodan-hasso-no-kamae		Same as Hasso-no-kamae
Kesa Giri	Kay-sah Gi-ree	Diagonal Cut top to bottom
Kiri Age	Key-ree-ah-gay	Diagonal Cut bottom to top
Makuri	Mah-koo-ree	Continuous swinging cuts
Nagashi	Nah-gah-shee	Looped cuts - transitioning from one to another cut
Seigan-no-kamae	Say-gahn-noh-kuh-mah-ey	Middle Stance
Waki-no-kamae	Waah-keeh-noh-kuh-mah-ey	Side stance with sword to the rear
Yoko Giri	Yoh-koh-ghi-ree	horizontal cut
Yoko kamae	Yoh-koh-kuh-mah-ey	side stance with sword to the front

Common Words Used in Aikido

Japanese Word	Approximate Pronunciation	Approximate Meaning
Aikido	Eye-key-doe	Ai=harmony, Ki=spirit, Do=The Way or Path
Aikidoka	Eye-key-doe-kah	Aikido Practitioner
Aiki Taiso	Eye-key Tie-so	Aikido Solo Warm-Up Exercises
Aiki Sotai	Eye-key So-tie	Aikido Partner Warm-Up Exercises
Atemi Waza	Ah-teh-mee Wah-zah	Striking Techniques
Bushido; Budo; Budoka	Boo-she-doe	Warrior's Code; The Way of the Warrior; Warrior
Chuden	Chew-then	Inner, or Middle-level Teachings
Dan	Dahn	Black Belt Rank
Deai	Day-eye	Timing in Action
Deshi	Day-she	Student, Pupil, Disciple
Do	Doh	Way, Path, Truth. Also torso (attack point in kendo; often to the exclamation "Do!")
Dogi	Doh-ghee	Training Costume
Dojo	Doe-joe	"Place of the Way"; Training Hall
Doshi	Doe-she	Comrade, Friend (Used Among Fellow Aikidoka)
En	En	Circle (as in En-no-irimi: Circular Entering)
Gaeshi; Kaeshi	Guy-eh-she	Reversed; To Reverse
Gi	Ghee	Training Costume (Dogi)
Hakama	Hah-kah-ma	A Divided, Pant-skirt that goes over the gi
Hanmi	Hahn-me	Triangular stance
Hanmi Handachi	Hahn-me Hahn-dah-chee	Nage (thrower) Kneeling; Uke (the attacker) Standing
Hantai	Hahn-tie	Opposite

Common Words Used in Aikido (Continued):

Japanese Word	Approximate Pronunciation	Approximate Meaning
Hara	Ha-rah	Lower abdomen, physical and spiritual center
Henka Waza	Hen-kah Wah-za	Multiple techniques off one attack
Hidari	He-dah-ree	Left (direction)
Hiji	He-jee	Elbow
Ikeda Sensei	Ih-kay-dhah	Aikikai shihan, second chief instructor of Aikido Schools of Ueshiba (note the soft “d” sound)
Irimi	Ee-ree-me	Entering movement
Jiyu Waza	Jee-you Wah-zah	Free style techniques/practice
Kaeshi; Gaeshi	Kah-eh-she	To reverse
Kaeshi Waza	Kah-eh-she wah-zah	Reversal technique
Kaiten	Kai-ten	To revolve or rotate
Kamae	Kuh-mah-ay	Stance, posture
Kata	Kah-tah	Shoulder. Also means "form practice of pre-arranged exercise(s)"
Katate	Kah-tah-tay	Wrist
Keiko	Kay-ko	Practice session; training
Kohai	Koh-hi	Junior student
Kote	Koh-tay	Wrist (attack point in kendo; often to the exclamation ”K’te!”)
Kotodama	Coe-thoe-dha-mah	The spiritual function of sound. Each syllable sound has its own spiritual vibration.
Ki	Key	Spirit, the vital force of the body; Universal Energy; A flow of positive energy
Kiai	Key-eye	Energy emerging from hara and focused to a point; may be accompanied by a piercing yell.
Ki No Nagare	Key-no-nah-gah-ray	Flowing movement
Kihon Waza	Key-hone-wah-zah	Basic technique
Kokoro	Co-co-roe	Heart, spirit ("keiko, kokoro, keiko, kokoro…")
Kokyu	Co-kyuh	Breath power, the coordination of ki flow with breathing, rhythm of technique
Kokyu Dosa; Kokyu Tanden Ho	Co-kyuh Doe-sah; Co-kyuh than-den ho	The foundational centering and connection practice in Aikido
Koshi	Koh-she	Hips, waist
Kubi	Coo-bee	Neck
Kyu	Cue	Aikido rank before black belt.
Maai	Mah-eye	Distance between uke and nage, meaning "harmony of space"
Men	Men	Face, head (also, an attack point in kendo; often to the exclamation “Men!”)
Migi	Mee-ghee	Right (direction)
Misogi	Mee-so-ghee	Cleansing, inner and outer
Mudansha	Moo-dahn-sha	White belt grade holder(s)
Mushin	Moo-shin	No mind, a mind without ego.
Musubi	Moo-sue-bee	Connection (literally: the steam that connects the grains of cooked rice)
Nage	Nah-gay	Throw, or the person who throws
Obi	Oh-bee	Belt
Okuden	Oh-koo-then	Higher, or secret teachings
O Sensei	Oh-sen-say	Great teacher: Morehei Ueshiba
Randori	Ran-doh-ri	Multiple attack
Rei	Ray	Salutation, bow
Reigi Saho	Ray-gi Sah-hoe	Etiquette
Ryote	Ryou-tay	Both hands
Saotome Sensei	Sah-oh-thoe-may	Aikikai shihan, founder of Aikido Schools of Ueshiba (note the soft “t” sound)
Samurai	Sa-moo-rye	Military retainer (feudal period)
Sankaku	Sahn-kah-koo	Three cornered (as in Sankaku-no-irimi: triangular entering)
Sempai	Sem-pie	Senior student
Sensei	Sen-say	Teacher (literally: “born before”). At 4th Dan or above
Seiza	Say-zah	Formal sitting posture
Shiho	She-ho	Four directions
Shihan	She-hahn	Master teacher. At 6th Dan or above
Shikko	She-coe	Knee-foot walking
Shime	She-may	To choke
Shizen Tai	Shi-zen-tie	Natural posture
Shodan	Show-dahn	Holder of the first grade black belt; first step; low sword stance
Shoden	Show-then	Outer, or beginning teachings
Shomen	Show-men	Front or top of the head

Common Words Used in Aikido (Continued):

Japanese Word	Approximate Pronunciation	Approximate Meaning
Shugyo	Shuh- ghyoh	Daily practice aiming to refine and purify the quality of life
Sutemi	Sue-teh-me	Sacrifice throw
Suwari Waza	Sue-wah-ree Wah-zah	Sitting techniques
Tachi	Tah-chee	Japanese sword, or "standing"
Tachi-Dori	Ta-chee Doe-ree	Techniques of taking an opponents sword
Tachi Waza	Ta-chee-wah-zah	Standing techniques
Taijutsu	Tie-ju-tsoo	Body arts: aikido techniques done without weapons
Tai No Henko	Tie-no-hen-ko	Basic blending practice; Kokyu Ho Tenkan
Tai Sabaki	Tie-sa-bah-kee	Whole body movement (as against merely moving the hands)
Takemusu Aiki	Tah-kay-moo-sue Eye-key	Infinite creativity of Aikido
Taninsugake	Tuh-nin-sue-gah-kay	Techniques with multiple people attacking simultaneously
Te	Tay	Hand
Tegatana	Tay-gah-tah-nah	Hand blade. Sword edge of the hand
Te Kubi	Tay-koo-bee	Wrist (literally, "neck of the hand")
Tenchi	Ten-chee	Ten=heaven, Chi=earth. A position of the hands, one high (up) and one low (down)
Tori	Taw-ree	Grab; in some schools: Nage
Tsuki	Tsu-kee	Thrust
Uchi	Oo-chee	To strike
Uke	Oo-kay	A person who receives a technique; the person being thrown
Ukemi	Oo-ke-me	The art of receiving technique while staying connected; flowing away from harm
Ushiro	Oo-she-row	Back, behind, rear
Waza	Wah-zah	Techniques
Yokomen	Yoh-ko-men	Side of the head
Yudansha	You-dahn-sha	Black belt grade holder(s)
Za	Zah	Sitting
Zanshin	Zahn-sheen	Continuous awareness

Numbers:

Japanese Word	Approximate Pronunciation	Approximate Meaning
Ichi	Ee-chee	One
Ni	Knee	Two
San	Sahn	Three
Shi/Yon	She/Yawn	Four
Go	Goh	Five
Roku	Roh-ku	Six
Shichi/Nana	She-chee/Nah-nah	Seven
Hachi	Hah-chee	Eight
Ku	Coo	Nine
Ju	Jyu	Ten
Ju-ichi, Ju-ni etc.		Eleven, Twelve etc.
Ni-ju, Ni-ju-ichi etc.		Twenty, Twenty one etc.
Hyaku, Sen, Man, Oku, Tyu		Hundred, Thousand, Ten thousand, One hundred million, Billion

Helpful Phrases:

Japanese Word	Approximate Pronunciation	Approximate Meaning
Ohayo Gozaimasu	Ohio Go-zah-ee-mahs	Good morning (before 10am)
Konnichi Wa	Kone-knee-chee Wah	Hello! Good day (after 10:00 am)
Komban Wa	Comb-bahn Wah	Good evening
Oyasumi Nasai	Oh-yah-sue-me Nah-sigh	Good night (before bedtime)
Sayonara	Sah-yoh-nah-rah	Good-bye
Arigato Gozaimasu	Ah-ree-gah-toe Go-zah-ee-mahss	Thank you
Sensei, Domo Arigato Gozaimashita	Sen-say, Doe-moe Ah-ree gah-toe Go-zah-ee-mah-she-tah	Sensei, thank you very much for what you have done (spoken by students at the end of aikido class)
Onegai Shimasu	Oh-nigh-guy She-mahss	I make a request. (spoken when one wishes to practice with another, or by the instructor asking class to practice)
Gomen Nasai	Go-men Nah-sigh	I'm sorry, excuse me
Do Itashimashite	Doe Ee-tah-she-mah-she-tay	Don't mention it. You're welcome
Ogenki Desu Ka	Oh-ghen-key Des-kah	How are you?
Okagesama De	Oh-kah-ghe-sama Day	Fine, thank you
Hajimemashite	Haji-may-mah-she-tay	Nice to meet you